

Research Ethics and Integrity Regulation — Regulation Document

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This regulation document gives effect to Research Ethics and Integrity Regulation and covers the purposes, responsibilities and operating expectations associated with Research Ethics. It should be read alongside supporting guidance and any subsequent circulars.

Background and Rationale

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this regulation document to give effect to Research Ethics, Integrity. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Research Ethics as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present regulation document responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

Purpose

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Research Ethics, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Integrity across the system.

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Policy Objectives

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Research Ethics, Integrity, Plagiarism, with clear lines of accountability.

The principal objectives are to strengthen Research Ethics, harmonise institutional approaches to Integrity, and establish measurable indicators through which progress can be tracked and reported.

Scope and Applicability

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Research Ethics within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Higher Education Department. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

Key Provisions

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Research Ethics, disclosure of material information to Higher Education Department, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

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Implementation Pathway

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

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Roles and Responsibilities

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Research Ethics, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Performance Monitoring

Progress will be monitored through annual institutional returns, targeted reviews and outcome indicators maintained centrally by Higher Education Department. Findings will inform guidance and, where necessary, corrective measures.

Closing Note

The success of this regulation rests on shared understanding and consistent application. Higher Education Department stands ready to support institutions in implementing Research Ethics and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.